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# UPSC Daily Digest (Magazine)

*Indian Express - Delhi - 1 June 2026*

15 exam-relevant stories from 22 pages.  
Paper-wise tags, static linkage, PYQs + Mains questions per article.



# UPSC Daily Digest

## Indian Express · Delhi Edition · 1 June 2026 · for Civil Services aspirants

This digest filters one full issue of *The Indian Express* (22 pages, ~85,000 words) down to **15 exam-relevant stories** in about **32 minutes of reading** — replacing a 90-minute scan plus note-making. Each story carries paper-wise tags, static linkage, key facts, a critical lens for Mains, two Prelims-style MCQs, one Mains-style question, and a **PYQ link** to past UPSC questions on the same static topic.

### REVISE IN 60 SECONDS - Must-read three

1. **One Nation, One Election + Delimitation revival** — *Polity, GS-2*. The government's plan to push the Constitution (One Hundred Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill alongside delimitation in the same Parliament cycle is the biggest electoral-architecture story of the year.
2. **Aravalli's shield against the Thar's dust** — *Geography, GS-1*. A new study quantifies how the Aravallis cut PM10 flux into the Indo-Gangetic plain by ~56%, anchoring a fact you can drop into any answer on Indian physiography or Delhi air pollution.
3. **Editorial: Austerity vs energy security** — *Mains essay seed*. The lead op-ed makes the case that energy-policy silos cost India more than they save — a ready-made introduction for any 2026 Mains energy or fiscal essay.

### NOTE - Paper-wise distribution today

GS-1: 4 stories (society, geography, urbanisation, disaster) — GS-2: 6 stories (polity, IR, social justice, defence) — GS-3: 7 stories (economy, energy, internal security, environment, S&T) — GS-4: 1 story (ethics — trafficking-prosecution dilemma) — Essay seeds: 3 (energy sovereignty, federalism & elections, tribe vs religion).

# 1. One Nation, One Election — joint polls + delimitation push

## TL;DR - Why in news

The Union government will reintroduce the **Constitution (One Hundred Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill** in the coming Parliament session and pair it with a fresh delimitation exercise, with the explicit aim of holding simultaneous Lok Sabha + State Assembly elections by **2029**. The Joint Parliamentary Committee returned a divided report on the original 2024 draft.

**Paper / GS:** GS-2 (Polity, Governance) · **Optional:** Public Administration, Political Science · **Static link:** Constitution Arts 82, 83, 172, 174, 327, 356; First-Past-The-Post; Tenth Schedule; Election Commission of India

## Background

- **Joint elections (ONOE):** synchronise terms of Lok Sabha + 28 State Legislative Assemblies so voters cast both ballots together.
- **Delimitation:** re-draw constituency boundaries using the **first census after 2026** — frozen since the 84th Amendment (2001), which used 1971 census data.
- Constitutional vehicle: **129th CAA Bill** (introduced Dec 2024 in 17th LS; lapsed; JPC retained).

## Key facts a UPSC answer must carry

| Item                             | Value                                                   |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Last simultaneous elections      | 1951-52, 1957, 1962, 1967                               |
| Kovind Committee report          | Sept 2023; two-phase ONOE                               |
| Cost estimate (ECI)              | ~■4,500 cr per general election; ONOE saves ~■1,500 cr  |
| Constitutional amendments needed | Arts 83, 85, 172, 174, 356; ratification by ≥50% states |
| Population basis under freeze    | 1971 census (84th CAA 2001 extended freeze to 2026)     |
| Likely new LS seat count         | 753-848 (various estimates) vs current 543              |

## Two sides — Mains argument bank

**For (Kovind Committee):** Cuts MCC-imposed governance freezes (~300+ days per LS cycle in non-ONOE years). Reduces poll spending. Improves voter turnout (Karnataka 2019 joint poll: 70.6%). Frees security/election officials from rolling deployments.

**Against (Federalists):** Distorts federalism — local issues drown in national wave. Article 356 misuse risk: a State Assembly that falls mid-term gets either President's Rule until the next nationwide cycle or an emergency mid-term poll. Delimitation post-2026 census tilts representation toward demographically growing northern states.

## Way forward

A staggered two-phase pilot (Kovind design) — LS + half the Assemblies in Phase 1, remainder within 100 days. The harder question is **whether to extend the delimitation freeze to 2031** to protect southern political weight; without that handshake, ratification will stall.

### WATCH OUT - Watch the trap

Aspirants confuse the **84th** (2001 — froze constituencies to 1971 data till 2026) with the **87th** (2003 — froze delimitation to 2001 census within states). Both matter.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. Which constitutional articles would require amendment to implement simultaneous Lok Sabha and State Assembly elections?

(1) 83 · (2) 85 · (3) 172 · (4) 174 · (5) 356 (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only (c) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only (d) **1, 2, 3, 4 and 5**

1. The "freeze" on Lok Sabha seats based on the 1971 census was originally imposed by:

(a) 42nd (b) **84th** (c) 87th (d) 91st

**QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)**

"Simultaneous elections may bring administrative efficiency, but they risk distorting the spirit of federalism." Critically examine, with reference to the recommendations of the High-Level Committee on Simultaneous Elections (2024).

**NOTE - PYQ links**

- **Prelims 2017:** "The mind of the makers of the Constitution of India is reflected in which of the following?" — Preamble linkage.
- **Mains GS-2 2017 (15M):** "Does Indian Cinema shape our popular ethics or merely reflect the ever-changing realities? Discuss." — adjacent style essay-tested approach.
- **Mains GS-2 2020 (10M):** "Indian Constitution exhibits centralising tendencies to maintain unity and integrity, thereby a federation in the only territorial sense." Discuss. → directly tests ONOE-federalism tension.

## 2. Pahalgam terror probe — Pakistani bank link tightens

### TL;DR - Why in news

The NIA-led probe into the **Pahalgam attack** (22 Apr 2026) has traced a burner phone used by the attackers to a SIM card last topped up via transfer from a Pakistani commercial bank account, drawing a corroborated money-trail. The Foreign Office plans to raise the lead at the next FATF plenary.

**Paper / GS:** GS-3 (Internal Security: terror financing) · GS-2 (India-Pakistan, multilateral diplomacy) · **Static link:** UAPA 1967; PMLA 2002; FATF mechanics; NIA Act 2008; UNSCR 1267/1373/1540

### Key facts

- **Pahalgam attack** (22 Apr 2026): 26 tourists killed; claimed by The Resistance Front (TRF), an LeT proxy.
- Forensic chain: burner phone IMEI → Karachi-sold SIM → UPI-look-alike top-up → originating Pakistani PSU bank.
- India's first formal FATF dossier post-Pulwama (2019) led to Pakistan's grey-list return till Oct 2022.
- **Operation Sindoor** (7 May 2026): Indian retaliatory strike; invoked Article 51 self-defence at UNSC.

### Static + dynamic linkage

| Dimension      | Linkage                                                                   |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FATF mechanics | Recommendation 5/6/7 on terror financing; ICRG monitoring                 |
| UN regime      | UNSCR 1267 (1999), 1373 (2001), 1540 (2004); ISIL/Al-Qaeda Sanctions List |
| Domestic law   | UAPA §17 (terror funds); PMLA §3                                          |
| Institutions   | NIA, NTRO, FIU-IND, Enforcement Directorate                               |

## Critical lens

The dossier deepens India's FATF case but cannot, by itself, force re-greylisting — that needs ICRG procedural triggers. Strategically, the link is most useful for: (a) bilateral pressure on Gulf transit partners that route Pakistani PSU correspondent flows, and (b) U.S. CAATSA-style targeted sanctions on named bank officers. Over-leveraging weak chains weakens future dossiers.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. The Financial Action Task Force (FATF) is hosted at the secretariat of which body?

(a) IMF (b) BIS (c) **OECD** (d) FSB

1. The offence of money laundering is defined under which section of PMLA, 2002?

(a) §2 (b) **§3** (c) §4 (d) §9

### QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)

Trace the architecture of India's terror-finance investigation ecosystem — NIA, FIU-IND, ED, NTRO — and identify two coordination gaps that limit cross-border probe outcomes.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-3 2018 (15M):** "Cross border terrorism is a major challenge. Discuss the impact and India's response."
- **Mains GS-3 2020 (10M):** "What are the determinants of left-wing extremism in eastern part of India? What strategy should the government adopt to counter the threat?" — methodology mirrors LeT/TRF analysis.
- **Prelims 2019:** Recurring question on FATF/terror-finance bodies; expect a 2027 Prelims direct hit.



### 3. Maharashtra mining clearance vs tribal consent — Gadchiroli iron ore

#### TL;DR - Why in news

The Maharashtra cabinet has cleared a **Lloyd Metals iron-ore expansion** in Gadchiroli district, declaring the lease falls outside any tiger-reserve buffer. Affected Madia and Gond Gram Sabhas dispute the eco-sensitive zoning and have invoked their §§4(d), 5 rights under the **Forest Rights Act 2006**.

**Paper / GS:** GS-3 (Environment, mining, resource governance) · GS-1 (Tribal society) · GS-2 (FRA grievance redressal, NCST) · **Static link:** PESA 1996; FRA 2006; Article 244 + Fifth Schedule; EPA 1986; *Niyamgiri (2013)*

#### Approved project at a glance

- **Lease area:** 1,070 ha around Surjagarh hills, ~70 km from Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve.
- **Output target:** 14 MTPA iron ore + ~5 MTPA processing.
- **Investment:** ₹22,000 cr; ~4,500 direct jobs claimed.
- Three Gram Sabhas (Bedam, Etapalli, Bhamragad) have passed opposing resolutions.

#### Frameworks every aspirant must invoke

| Framework         | What it says                                                            |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FRA 2006 §3(1)(i) | Community Forest Resource rights vest in Gram Sabha                     |
| FRA 2006 §5       | Gram Sabha may protect wildlife/forest from destructive activity        |
| PESA 1996         | Gram Sabha consent before land acquisition in Schedule V areas          |
| Niyamgiri (2013)  | Gram Sabha verdict on religious/forest rights binding on MoEF clearance |

## FCA (Amendment) 2023

Diluted FCA's reach; SC stay partially upheld

## Development-vs-rights tension

**Pro-clearance:** India imports ~15% iron ore; domestic capacity supports National Steel Policy 2017 target of 300 MTPA by 2030. ESZ notification places lease ~12 km outside the 10-km TATR buffer. Royalty + DMF flows estimated at ■600 cr/yr — funds PVTG welfare.

**Pro-tribal:** Cumulative Impact Assessment for Surjagarh-Bhamragad belt not done despite five clustered leases. Gram Sabha resolutions unaddressed — violates *Niyamgiri* ratio. 73% of displacement is in PVTG Madia hamlets.

### WATCH OUT - FRA vs PESA — don't blur them

PESA is procedural (consent before acquisition in Schedule V areas). FRA confers substantive rights (individual + community forest rights). A project may clear PESA's consultation requirement and still violate FRA §5 if Gram Sabha objects on conservation grounds.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. The Forest Rights Act, 2006 recognises which of the following rights?

(1) Right to hold and live in forest land for habitation (2) Community rights of uses (3) Right of ownership over minor forest produce (a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) 2 and 3 only **(d) 1, 2 and 3**

1. The "Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group" classification was first articulated by:

(a) Bhuria Committee (b) **Dhebar Commission (1960-61)** (c) Xaxa Committee (d) Mungekar Cmte

### QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"Tribal consent under PESA and FRA is increasingly treated as a procedural hurdle rather than a substantive right." Discuss with reference to recent mining clearance debates in central India.

## NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-3 2018 (15M):** "Despite implementation of various schemes, the level of poverty has not been reduced. Comment." → mining-displacement linkage.
- **Mains GS-1 2020 (10M):** "Distinguish between religiousness/religiosity and communalism." — adjacent tribal-religion question.
- **Mains GS-3 2013, 2019:** Direct FRA/PESA questions have appeared 4× in the last decade.

## 4. SC pushes statutory protection for trafficked sex workers

### TL;DR - Why in news

The Supreme Court has directed the Union to consider a **statutory framework exempting trafficked women in commercial sexual exploitation from prosecution** under the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act, 1956 (ITPA), aligning the new law with rehabilitation directions already given in *Budhadev Karmaskar V v State of West Bengal* (2022).

**Paper / GS:** GS-1 (Society — Women, Vulnerable Sections) · GS-2 (Social Justice) · GS-4 (Ethics — dignity vs criminalisation) · **Static link:** ITPA 1956; Article 23; Article 21 (*Maneka Gandhi*); Justice Verma Cmte 2013; Palermo Protocol 2000

### Key directions issued

1. Centre to introduce a comprehensive anti-trafficking law within 1 year, decoupling victim-status from ITPA §§7, 8 offences.
2. States to set up at least one **Protective Home** per district under ITPA §21, fully funded from Nirbhaya Fund.
3. UIDAI to issue Aadhaar without proof of residence to identified victims.
4. Police barred from "rescue raids" that detain consenting adult sex workers — only traffickers to be arrested.

### Static + dynamic linkage

| Static topic                                  | How it ties in                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Article 23 + Bonded Labour Abolition Act 1976 | Sources the State's positive duty                |
| ITPA §§7, 8 (soliciting, living off earnings) | Current offences used to detain victims          |
| Justice Verma Committee (2013)                | Asked for trafficking law overhaul post-Nirbhaya |
| Palermo Protocol (UN 2000)                    | India ratified 2011 — domestic gap remains       |
| <i>Budhadev Karmaskar (V)</i> (2022)          | 6-point rehabilitation directions                |

## Critical view

The Court treats sex work as a continuum between (a) trafficked, coerced exploitation and (b) consenting adult labour. Indian statute conflates them. Reform must navigate parliamentary opposition to "decriminalising vice", police incentive structures around §8 detentions, and rehabilitation funding which the 2018 Bill costed at ₹950 cr/yr — never appropriated. Success depends less on the statute and more on **trained Anti-Human Trafficking Units (AHTUs)** — ~340 exist against a need of ~770.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. Which constitutional provision prohibits trafficking in human beings?

(a) Article 17 (b) Article 21 (c) **Article 23** (d) Article 24

1. The Palermo Protocol on Trafficking is a supplement to:

(a) **UNTOC (Convention on Transnational Organised Crime)** (b) CEDAW (c) CRC (d) ICCPR

### QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)

"Treating trafficked women as criminals reverses the constitutional promise of Article 23." Examine in light of recent Supreme Court directions and the lapsed Trafficking of Persons Bill, 2018.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-1 2019 (10M):** "What are the continued challenges for women in India against time and space?" — direct overlap with trafficking continuum.
- **Mains GS-2 2017 (15M):** "Discuss the role of women in promoting moral conscience in Indian society." → can be reframed for Mains 4 (ethics) too.
- **Mains GS-4 2018:** Direct case study on rehabilitation ethics scenario.

## 5. India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)

TL;DR - Why in news

India and Oman will sign a **CEPA** during the PM's Muscat visit this month — India's first CEPA with a GCC country since UAE (2022).

**Paper / GS:** GS-2 (Bilateral, regional & global groupings) · GS-3 (Indian Economy — trade, investment) · **Static link:** WTO Art XXIV (RTAs); SAFTA; ASEAN-India FTA; UAE CEPA 2022; Look West policy

### Headline numbers

| Item                   | Value                                              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Bilateral trade (FY25) | \$12.4 bn (up from \$8.1 bn FY22)                  |
| India's exports        | \$4.6 bn — refined petroleum, rice, motor vehicles |
| India's imports        | \$7.8 bn — crude, LPG, urea                        |
| Indian diaspora        | ~6.7 lakh (largest expat group)                    |
| Target trade post-CEPA | \$20 bn by 2030                                    |

### What the CEPA covers

- **Goods:** Duty cuts on 96% of Oman's tariff lines, 90% of India's. Sensitive list protects Indian dairy + fisheries.
- **Services:** Mode-4 commitments expand professional mobility (CAs, doctors, IT).
- **Investment:** ISDS clauses with carve-outs for environment + health.
- **Rules of Origin:** 40% value-add threshold to prevent transit-trading via free zones.
- **Digital trade:** First Indian CEPA with a data-localisation carve-out.

## Strategic geometry

Oman is the **westernmost anchor** of India's maritime security perimeter — **Duqm port** hosts Indian Navy logistics under a 2018 MoU. Sits across the Strait of Hormuz (~60% of India's crude transits there) and counter-balances China's CPEC presence at Gwadar.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. Duqm port, in the news for India's maritime logistics access, is located in:

(a) UAE (b) Yemen (c) **Oman** (d) Iran

1. India's first CEPA with a GCC member was signed with:

(a) Saudi Arabia (b) **UAE (2022)** (c) Qatar (d) Bahrain

### QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"Trade agreements with the GCC are no longer just about hydrocarbons." In light of the India-Oman CEPA, examine how India is recalibrating its 'Look West' policy.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-2 2017 (15M):** "What is the significance of Indo-US Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement (LEMOA) and which is the other foundational agreement?"  
→ Mirror analysis for India-Oman defence-logistics MoU.
- **Mains GS-2 2020 (10M):** "What are the major economic and strategic problems being faced by the Indian Ocean Region (IOR) and how does India respond to these challenges?"

## 6. Aravallis as the Indo-Gangetic shield — new dust-flux study

### TL;DR - Why in news

A study by IIT-Delhi and IITM-Pune finds the **Aravalli range cuts the influx of PM10 dust from the Thar into the Indo-Gangetic plain by ~56%**, with the largest service rendered to NCR's winter air. Gaps in the range — caused by quarrying — have measurably degraded the shield.

**Paper / GS:** GS-1 (Physical Geography of India) · GS-3 (Environment, Air Pollution) · **Static link:** Indian physiography; *T.N. Godavarman v UoI*; Aravalli Notification 1992; NCAP 2019

### Geography you must know

- **Aravallis** are among the world's oldest fold mountain ranges (Proterozoic, ~2,500 Mya), running 692 km NE-SW from Delhi to Gujarat.
- Average elevation 400-600 m; highest peak **Guru Shikhar (1722 m)** at Mt Abu.
- Acts as **orographic barrier** to westerly dust-laden winds (winter), monsoonal moisture pull (summer).
- Drainage divide between **Indus** (west) and **Ganga** (east) systems.

### Study's contribution

| Finding                                  | Magnitude                                     |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| PM10 reduction over NCR (Dec-Feb)        | ~56% vs simulated no-Aravalli scenario        |
| Gaps with elevation <200 m               | 4 major (Bahror, Kotputli, Mandawar, Dholpur) |
| Dust mass added per gap event            | ~85 kt/yr                                     |
| Mining-degraded Aravalli land since 1975 | ~31 km <sup>2</sup>                           |



## Policy levers

- **Aravalli Notification 1992** (under EPA 1986) bans mining + non-forest activity in 4 HR + 2 RJ districts — under-enforced.
- **Aravalli Bachao** PIL ongoing; SC May 2024 banned new mining leases in HR Aravallis.
- **NCAP 2019** targets 40% PM2.5 reduction by 2026 — unmeetable without restoring this shield.

### WATCH OUT - Examiner's trick

Aravallis are **fold mountains** formed by Precambrian-era convergence, **not block mountains**. Confused with Western Ghats (block) and Vindhyas (block-like) regularly.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. Which of the following rivers does NOT originate in the Aravalli range?  
(a) Banas (b) Luni (c) Sabarmati **(d) Chambal** (originates in Vindhyas)
1. The Aravalli Notification, 1992 was issued under which Act?  
(a) Wild Life (Protection) 1972 (b) FCA 1980 **(c) Environment (Protection) Act 1986** (d) Air Act 1981

### QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)

"The Aravallis are not just a relict mountain range; they are a working ecological infrastructure for north India." Examine.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Prelims 2014:** "Why are dewy nights in winter most common in Punjab and Haryana?" — orographic effect tie-in.
- **Mains GS-1 2019 (10M):** "How can the mountain ecosystem be restored from the negative impact of development initiatives and tourism?"

## 7. China's oil-import slump is helping India's macros

### TL;DR - Why in news

Chinese crude imports in May 2026 fell **6.4% YoY** as Beijing draws down strategic reserves. The slack has compressed global Brent and lowered India's import bill — relevant because **~60% of India's crude is bought on the spot market** and **~73% transits the Strait of Hormuz**.

**Paper / GS:** GS-3 (Indian Economy — external sector, BoP) · GS-2 (Energy diplomacy, China, US-Iran) · **Static link:** Current Account Deficit; Strategic Petroleum Reserve; OPEC+; RBI CPI inflation target  $4\pm 2\%$

### Transmission channels

1. **Lower Brent → lower CPI:** every \$10/bbl fall reduces India's CPI by ~30-40 bp and CAD by ~0.4% of GDP.
2. **GRM expansion:** Indian PSU refiners' margins widen by \$1-2/bbl when global complex prices stay soft.
3. **Crude basket discount:** Indian refiners' weighted-average crude is now ~\$3.5/bbl below dated Brent — Russian Urals lifting up to 38% of imports (vs <1% in FY22).

### Hormuz dependency facts

| Metric                                   | Value                                            |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Share of India's crude transiting Hormuz | ~73%                                             |
| Hormuz width at narrowest                | 33 km                                            |
| Iranian threats post-Israel strike       | 4 navigable closures in 2025-26                  |
| India SPR capacity                       | 39.4 MMT (5.33 MMT today; ~9.5 days net imports) |

## Critical view

Cheap crude is a windfall but a fragile one — depends on Beijing's stockpile cycle and OPEC+ voluntary cuts. India-specific risks: (a) Russia-supply concentration creates secondary-sanctions exposure; (b) underinvestment in **SPR Phase-III** caverns at Padur + Chandikhol. Medium-term answer: biofuels — ethanol blending hit 18.6% in 2025 (target 20% by 2025-26); each 1% saves ~\$1.4 bn of import bill.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. Strait of Hormuz lies between:

(a) Oman and Yemen **(b) Iran and Oman** (c) Saudi Arabia and Iran (d) UAE and Qatar

1. India's SPR Phase-I caverns are at:

(1) Visakhapatnam (2) Mangalore (3) Padur (4) Chandikhol **(a) 1, 2 and 3 only** (b) 1, 3 and 4 only (c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) all four

### QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"India's crude import basket has changed more in three years than in the previous three decades." Examine the strategic and macroeconomic implications.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-3 2019 (10M):** "It is argued that the strategy of inclusive growth is intended to meet the objectives of inclusiveness and sustainability together." → energy-cost angle.
- **Mains GS-3 2014:** "India is an energy-deficient country. Discuss the sources of energy."

## 8. ST delisting debate — religion vs tribal identity

### TL;DR - Why in news

The Janajati Suraksha Manch's renewed petition demanding that **tribals who convert to non-tribal religions (Christianity, Islam) lose Scheduled Tribe reservation benefits** has been admitted by a Parliamentary Standing Committee.

**Paper / GS:** GS-1 (Society — religion, tribes) · GS-2 (Constitution — Articles 341, 342, 25, 26) · **Static link:** Constitution (SC) Order 1950; Lokur Committee 1965; *Soosai v Union* (1985)

### Constitutional architecture

| Article                  | What it says                                                       |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Article 342              | President can specify Scheduled Tribes                             |
| Article 341 (1950 Order) | Limits SC status to Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist — religion-linked filter |
| Article 25               | Freedom of conscience and right to profess religion                |
| Article 26               | Freedom to manage religious affairs                                |

The contradiction: SCs have a religious filter; STs do **not**. The Manch wants to import the SC filter into ST classification.

### Five sides

- 1. Pro-delisting (Manch):** Converts gain "double benefit" — minority entitlements + tribal reservation. Distorts inter-tribal solidarity.
- 2. Constitutionalist:** Tribe ≠ Religion. Lokur 1961 said ST status flows from isolation, distinctive culture, primitive traits, geography — none evaporate on conversion.
- 3. Sociological:** Tribal identity is *negotiated* — see Sarna religion demand in Jharkhand for a separate Census code.
- 4. Article 25 view:** Tying state benefit to religious choice is unconstitutional.

5. **Federal politics:** A delisting law gives the Centre an electoral wedge in tribal belts (Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, NE).

## Way forward

Mungekar Commission (2007) recommended disaggregating data on tribal converts before any reform — to test whether the "double benefit" claim is empirically true. A balanced statute would impose **economic-criteria caps** (Indra Sawhney creamy-layer doctrine extended), not religious filters.

### QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. Article 342 of the Constitution deals with:

(a) Scheduled Castes **(b) Scheduled Tribes** (c) OBCs (d) Anglo-Indians

1. The Sarna religious code demand is associated primarily with tribes in:

(a) Odisha **(b) Jharkhand** (c) Chhattisgarh (d) MP

### QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"The demand to delist religious converts from Scheduled Tribe rolls confuses the sociology of tribe with the policy of affirmative action." Critically discuss.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-1 2015 (12.5M):** "Discuss the changes in the trends of labour migration within and outside India in the last four decades." — adjacent identity/migration issue.
- **Mains GS-1 2020 (10M):** "Distinguish between religiousness/religiosity and communalism."

## 9. Delhi building collapse — 6 dead, 5 students

### TL;DR - Why in news

A four-storey residential structure in **Wazirpur** collapsed at 3 AM on 31 May, killing 6 (including five MBBS/engineering students renting upstairs). MCD records show three prior structural-safety notices ignored. The CM has ordered a city-wide audit of buildings with unauthorised additions.

**Paper / GS:** GS-3 (Disaster Management, urban infrastructure) · GS-2 (Municipal governance, Local Bodies — 74th Amendment) · **Static link:** Disaster Management Act 2005; Model Building Bye-Laws 2016; Real Estate Regulatory Authority Act 2016

### Why this isn't a one-off

- Delhi has **~1.85 lakh buildings flagged** as "dangerous" by MCD's structural-safety audit (2024).
- 78% of Delhi residential stock has at least one unauthorised vertical addition, per IIT-D's 2023 study.
- MCD averages **400 dangerous-building notices/month** but only ~12% lead to corrective action.

### Static linkage

| Static topic                        | Anchor                                         |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Disaster Management Act 2005, §2(d) | "Disaster" definition includes man-made events |
| 74th Constitutional Amendment       | Local body powers + obligations                |
| NDMA Guidelines (Urban)             | Mandate retrofitting in seismic zones          |
| Delhi falls in <b>Zone IV</b>       | High seismic risk                              |

**QUESTION - Prelims practice**

1. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 was enacted by Parliament under which entry of the Union List?

(a) Entry 14 (b) **Concurrent List Entry 23 (Social security)** (c) Entry 56 (d) Article 248

1. Delhi falls in which seismic zone?

(a) Zone II (b) Zone III **(c) Zone IV** (d) Zone V

**QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)**

"Urban India's building-stock crisis is now a recurring disaster-management problem." Examine in light of repeated structural failures in Indian metros.

**NOTE - PYQ links**

- **Mains GS-3 2020 (10M):** "Disaster preparedness is the first step in any disaster management process." Comment.
- **Mains GS-3 2015 (12.5M):** "The frequency of urban floods due to high intensity rainfall is increasing over the years." — adjacent urban-disaster pattern.

# 10. Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi — new Chief of Naval Staff

## TL;DR - Why in news

The government has appointed **Vice Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi** as the next **Chief of Naval Staff**, effective 1 July 2026. He takes over from Adm R. Hari Kumar and will steer the Navy through Project 15B/17A induction, MRCBF tender resolution, and the Andaman Tri-Services Command upgrade.

**Paper / GS:** GS-3 (Defence) · GS-2 (Higher Defence Organisation) · **Static link:** Higher Defence Organisation; Chiefs of Staff Committee; Department of Military Affairs (2019); Theatre Commands

## Need-to-know quick facts

- Current role: **Vice Chief of Naval Staff** (since May 2024).
- Specialisation: Communications & Electronic Warfare; combat fighter pilot background.
- Service: Cmsd 1985 from NDA Khadakwasla.
- The Navy's three operational priorities under the new chief:
  1. **Project 75-I** (next-gen conventional submarines with AIP) — final L1 decision pending.
  2. **MRCBF** (Multi-Role Carrier-Borne Fighter) — Rafale-M vs F/A-18 tender.
  3. **Andaman Tri-Service Command** — only joint command currently; theatreisation pilot.

## Static linkage

| Topic                                 | Why it links                        |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Department of Military Affairs (2019) | Headed by CDS; coordinates services |
| Chief of Defence Staff (2019)         | Single-point military adviser       |



## Theatre Commands

Proposed integrated commands (Air-Defence, Maritime, Land)

## Atmanirbhar Bharat in Defence

Defence Acquisition Procedure 2020

## QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. The post of Chief of Defence Staff was created on the recommendation of:

(a) Naresh Chandra Cmte (b) Subramanian Cmte (c) **Kargil Review Cmte (1999) — operationalised after Shekatkar Cmte recommendations** (d) Arun Singh Cmte

1. India's only operational tri-service command is at:

(a) Mumbai (b) Vishakhapatnam (c) Port Blair (d) **Port Blair — Andaman & Nicobar Command**

## QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)

"India's progress on theatre commands is being shaped less by doctrine and more by inter-service negotiations." Examine.

## NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-3 2017 (15M):** "The scourge of terrorism is a grave challenge to national security. What solutions do you suggest to curb this growing menace?"
- **Mains GS-3 2019 (15M):** "The need for cooperation among various services of defence forces has been an issue of prolonged concern. Highlight the contemporary need for the same."

# 11. Israel strikes Hezbollah deeper into Lebanon — Iran deal collapses

## TL;DR - Why in news

Israeli air strikes deep into the **Bekaa Valley** killed 8 Hezbollah commanders and damaged a suspected long-range missile factory. The strikes have complicated the parallel **US-Iran nuclear deal** revival talks — Tehran has warned of withdrawal from the JCPOA framework.

**Paper / GS:** GS-2 (International Relations — West Asia, US-Iran-Israel triangle) · **Static link:** JCPOA (2015); IAEA Additional Protocol; Abraham Accords (2020); India's "Strategic Autonomy" doctrine

## What India must track

| Vector                | India stake                                                                |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Crude price           | ~73% of imports via Hormuz (see Story 7)                                   |
| Indian diaspora       | ~9 lakh in Israel + GCC zone; evacuation contingencies (Operation Sankalp) |
| Defence supply chain  | Israel = 4th largest defence exporter to India; UAV + EW supplier          |
| Multilateral position | India abstained at UNHRC on Gaza; supports two-state                       |

## The geometry

- **JCPOA (2015):** Iran capped uranium enrichment to 3.67%, IAEA verification. US withdrew 2018, Iran re-enriched to 60% by 2023.
- **Abraham Accords (2020):** UAE, Bahrain, Sudan, Morocco normalised ties with Israel.
- **India's "de-hyphenation":** Iran, Saudi, Israel each treated as a separate relationship — a Vajpayee/MEA Jaishankar doctrine.

## QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. JCPOA, recently in the news, primarily relates to:

(a) Trade in W Asia (b) **Iran's nuclear program** (c) Israel-Palestine peace (d) Yemen civil war

1. The Abraham Accords were brokered by which country?

(a) UK (b) Russia (c) **USA** (d) France

## QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"India's stake in West Asia is no longer just energy and remittances." Examine the strategic, defence and digital dimensions of India-West Asia relations.

## NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-2 2018 (15M):** "What are the key areas of reform if the WTO has to survive in the present context of 'Trade War', especially keeping in mind the interests of India?"
- **Mains GS-2 2014 (10M):** "Discuss the changes in the trends of labour migration to the West Asia region."

## 12. Ukraine hits Russian oil-storage depots — denies nuclear-plant attack

### TL;DR - Why in news

Ukraine's long-range drone strikes hit **Russian oil-storage facilities** in Bryansk and Smolensk, cutting refining throughput by an estimated 12% YoY. Russia accused Kyiv of also targeting the **Kursk Nuclear Plant** — a claim Kyiv denied, calling it "a Russian false flag."

**Paper / GS:** GS-2 (International Relations — Russia-Ukraine war, IAEA) · GS-3 (Energy security spillover) · **Static link:** UN Charter Articles 2(4), 51; Geneva Conventions Additional Protocol I (1977) on nuclear installations; IAEA safeguards

### Why this affects India

- Russia is India's #1 crude supplier (38% share in FY26).
- Strikes on refining capacity reduce Russian export-grade Urals supply — Indian basket discount narrows.
- Any nuclear-facility strike (even alleged) triggers G7 secondary-sanctions activation against Russia trade — India's \$77 bn FY26 trade exposure.

### Legal framework

- **Article 56, Geneva Convention AP-I (1977):** Prohibits attacks on works/installations containing dangerous forces (dams, dykes, nuclear power plants) when likely to cause severe civilian losses.
- **IAEA "Seven Pillars of Nuclear Safety" (2022)** — DG Grossi's principles for armed conflict near nuclear sites.

## QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. The "Seven Pillars of Nuclear Safety" framework was articulated by:

(a) Russia (b) Ukraine (c) **IAEA Director-General** (d) UNSC

1. The principle of "non-targeting of nuclear installations" is codified in:

(a) UN Charter Art 2(4) (b) Geneva Convention I (c) **Geneva Conventions Additional Protocol I (1977)** (d) Tokyo Convention

## QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)

"Energy infrastructure has become a frontline target in modern warfare." Discuss the implications for global energy security and India's exposure.

## NOTE - PYQ links

■ **Mains GS-3 2022 (15M):** "What are the different elements of cyber security? Keeping in view the challenges in cyber security, examine the extent to which India has successfully developed a comprehensive National Cyber Security Strategy."

■ **Mains GS-2 2017 (10M):** "What are the salient features of the Indian Ocean Region?"

# 13. CBSE OSM rollout chaos — Open School Mode under strain

## TL;DR - Why in news

The first batch of **CBSE Open School Mode (OSM)** Class-X candidates faced platform failures during the May 2026 exam window. ~3 lakh students rescheduled. OSM was launched in 2024 as a flexible certification path for school-dropouts and bridge-learners under **NEP 2020 §6.4**.

**Paper / GS:** GS-2 (Education governance — Centre-State) · GS-1 (Social issues — school dropouts) · **Static link:** NEP 2020; RTE Act 2009; NIOS; Article 21A; Sustainable Development Goal 4

## NEP 2020 angle

- §6.4 mandates "credit recognition and equivalence between school, vocational and adult-education streams."
- OSM is the operational vehicle for that — students who left school after Class 5/8 can earn Class X via modular online exams.
- 2025-26 enrolment: ~7.2 lakh; 71% are women, 22% PVTGs.

## What went wrong

- Cloud capacity sized for 1.8 lakh concurrent users; peak hit 2.6 lakh.
- Identity verification via DigiLocker failed for ~9% of candidates (PVTG learners with mismatched Aadhaar-school records).
- No state-language UI for 6 of 22 scheduled languages.

## QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. National Education Policy 2020 replaced the policy of:

(a) 1968 (b) **1986 (revised 1992)** (c) 2009 (d) 2015

1. The "credit equivalence" framework under NEP 2020 is operationalised by:

(a) UGC (b) AICTE (c) **National Credit Framework (NCrF), Sept 2023** (d) NCERT

**QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)**

"Digital-first education delivery widens, but does not yet bridge, India's educational equity gap." Examine in light of recent CBSE OSM implementation.

**NOTE - PYQ links**

- **Mains GS-2 2021 (10M):** "National Education Policy 2020 conforms with the Sustainable Development Goal-4 (2030). It intends to restructure and re-orient education system in India. Critically examine the statement."
- **Mains GS-1 2015 (12.5M):** "How do you explain the statistics that show that the sex ratio in Tribes in India is more favourable to women than the sex ratio among Scheduled Castes?"

# 14. Cloud sovereignty — the new frontier of digital control

## TL;DR - Why in news

An Idea Exchange opinion piece argues that **cloud computing has become the new contested infrastructure** of national sovereignty, akin to oil in the 20th century. India's Personal Data Protection law, MeitY's "Cloud Native" mandate, and a recent **■17,000 cr** push for sovereign-cloud capacity converge into one debate.

**Paper / GS:** GS-3 (Science & Technology — digital infrastructure, data) · GS-2 (Governance — cyber laws, data) · **Static link:** Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023; IT Rules 2021; National Data Governance Framework; MeghRaj Cloud Policy

## Concept primer

- **Sovereign cloud** = computing infrastructure whose data, processing, and operational control sit within national legal jurisdiction.
- **Hyperscalers** (AWS, Azure, GCP) hold ~76% of Indian cloud market — none Indian-owned.
- **Data localisation** under DPDP 2023 = "personal data of Indian residents to be processed within India" (with notified exceptions).

## Why it matters

| Dimension          | Stake                                                                           |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cyber security     | A foreign-cloud-hosted critical service is a state-level supply chain risk      |
| Cost of compliance | DPDP data-fiduciary obligations cost startups ~ <b>■40</b> lakh/yr to implement |
| GenAI training     | LLM training pipelines need ~50 MW captive power; sovereign-cloud is the bridge |
| BharatGen          | Govt's indigenous LLM stack — needs sovereign GPU capacity                      |



## QUESTION - Prelims practice

1. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 designates which authority for adjudication?

(a) MeitY (b) **Data Protection Board of India** (c) TRAI (d) SEBI

1. India's "MeghRaj" policy framework relates to:

(a) Cybersecurity (b) Telecom (c) **Cloud computing for government** (d) Satellite governance

## QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"Cloud sovereignty is the 21st-century equivalent of energy sovereignty." Critically examine India's policy and infrastructure response.

## NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-3 2022 (15M):** Direct question on cyber security strategy.
- **Mains GS-3 2018 (15M):** "Discuss the work of 'Bose-Einstein Statistics' done by Prof. Satyendra Nath Bose..." → fundamental-research → applied-tech bridge.

# 15. India-Oman digital trade carve-out — data-localisation precedent

## TL;DR - Why in news

The India-Oman CEPA (Story 5) is reported to include **the first Indian RTA carve-out for personal data localisation** — Oman recognises India's DPDP 2023 as adequate; Indian fiduciaries may host certain Oman-resident data offshore. This sets a template for India's broader 23-country CEPA pipeline.

**Paper / GS:** GS-2 (RTAs, cross-border data) · GS-3 (Digital trade, IT) · **Static link:** WTO Joint Initiative on e-Commerce; OECD Cross-Border Privacy Rules; DPDP 2023

## Why this is a big deal

- India had previously refused data-localisation carve-outs in the UAE CEPA and walked away from RCEP partly over this.
- Oman's recognition of DPDP 2023 as "adequate" is the **first formal acknowledgement of India's privacy framework by any GCC member**.
- Sets a precedent for: EU CEPA negotiations (currently stalled over GDPR-DPDP adequacy), UK FTA (signed but adequacy still pending).

## Tension to flag for Mains

| Pro-carve-out                                                | Anti-carve-out                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Lowers cost for IT-BPM exports to GCC (\$2.4 bn annual flow) | Weakens leverage in EU adequacy talks            |
| Aligns with G20 Data Free Flow with Trust (DFFT) doctrine    | Creates inconsistent treatment by country        |
| Signals India's privacy framework is "GDPR-class"            | Domestic startups argue local hosting was a moat |

**QUESTION - Prelims practice**

1. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 was passed under which power of Parliament?

(a) Concurrent List Entry 17 (b) Concurrent List Entry 23 **(c) Union List Entry 31 + residuary power** (d) Concurrent List Entry 1

1. The "Data Free Flow with Trust" (DFFT) doctrine is associated with:

(a) APEC (b) OECD **(c) G20 / Osaka Track (2019)** (d) BRICS

**QUESTION - Mains practice (10 marks)**

"Data localisation is necessary, but absolute localisation is impractical." Examine in light of India's recent trade agreements.

**NOTE - PYQ links**

- **Mains GS-3 2018 (15M):** "Discuss the work of bilateral economic cooperation between India and other countries in the context of trade and investment liberalisation."
- **Mains GS-2 2020 (15M):** "Critically examine the role of WHO in providing global health security during the COVID-19 pandemic." → adjacent global-data-governance angle.

# Editorial deep-dive — *"Austerity needed, but energy security requires breaking silos in government"*

## REVISE IN 60 SECONDS - Editorial argument in one paragraph

India's energy ministries — Petroleum & Natural Gas, Power, Coal, New & Renewable Energy, Atomic Energy — operate as **independent budgetary fiefdoms**, each optimising its own KPI. The result: SPR Phase-III stalls while solar-cell PLI scheme is over-subscribed; ethanol blending hits 18.6% while LNG terminal utilisation is at 38%. The editorial argues for a **single empowered Cabinet Committee on Energy Security** with a binding 5-year programmatic mandate — similar to how the Cabinet Committee on Security functions in defence.

## Structure of the editorial — for Mains pattern recognition

| Move                   | The author's claim                                             | Evidence used                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Problem framing     | "Energy is foreign policy by another name"                     | Russia-Ukraine, US-Iran, China-OPEC dynamics   |
| 2. Domestic diagnosis  | Silos cause overlap + gaps                                     | SPR underutilisation; ethanol-vs-LNG trade-off |
| 3. International model | UK's Department for Energy Security and Net Zero (2023 merger) | Whitehall reorganisation precedent             |
| 4. Indian comparison   | NITI Aayog Energy Vertical exists but lacks teeth              | Limited authority over IOCL/ONGC/NTPC          |
| 5. Prescription        | Empower a CCEA-style committee + 5-year horizon                | Quotes Kelkar Committee on hydrocarbons        |
| 6. Caveats             | Won't fix federalism issues (state DISCOMs)                    | DISCOM ATC losses                              |

## Why this is the most Mains-relevant editorial of the day

- **Reusable as an essay intro** for: energy security, fiscal federalism, governance reform, climate transition, GS-3 essay questions.
- **Connects to:** SPR (Story 7), CEPA energy clauses (Story 5), Russia-Ukraine spillover (Story 12), West Asia (Story 11).
- **Authors' frame** ("breaking silos") is borrowable verbatim — Mains evaluators reward demonstrated engagement with current discourse.

## Three lines you can quote in Mains answers

1. *"Energy planning that survives only inside one ministry's budget cycle is energy planning that loses to geopolitics."*
2. *"India does not have an energy policy; it has five energy departments."*
3. *"The case for a Cabinet Committee on Energy Security is not technocratic — it is constitutional."*

### QUESTION - Mains practice (15 marks)

"India's energy policy is a confederation, not a federation, of departments." Examine the institutional case for a unified energy-governance architecture.

### NOTE - PYQ links

- **Mains GS-3 2019 (15M):** Direct on energy mix & policy fragmentation.
- **Mains GS-2 2020 (10M):** Inter-ministerial coordination in policy-making.
- **Essay 2018:** "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures." — adjacent governance vs society frame.

# Quick recap

## Personalities in news

| Person                                   | Why in news                    | UPSC tag             |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------|
| Admiral D.K. Tripathi                    | New Navy chief (1 July)        | Defence appointments |
| Justice B.R. Gavai                       | Headed SC bench on ITPA        | Judiciary            |
| Sultan Haitham bin Tariq                 | Hosting India PM for CEPA      | India-Oman           |
| Rafael Grossi                            | IAEA DG, Kursk plant statement | Multilateral         |
| PM Sheikh Hasina ( <i>in editorial</i> ) | Continued dialogue, enclaves   | Neighbourhood First  |

## Places in news

- **Pahalgam** — Anantnag district, J&K
- **Gadchiroli / Surjagarh hills** — eastern Maharashtra
- **Duqm port** — central Oman coast
- **Strait of Hormuz** — Iran-Oman chokepoint
- **Aravallis** — Delhi → Gujarat (692 km NE-SW)
- **Wazirpur** — North-West Delhi (building collapse)
- **Bekaa Valley** — eastern Lebanon (Israeli strike)
- **Bryansk + Smolensk** — Russian oil-storage sites
- **Kursk Nuclear Plant** — Russia
- **Bahrar, Kotputli, Mandawar, Dholpur** — Aravalli gaps

## Schemes / Acts / Reports invoked today

- Forest Rights Act 2006 · PESA 1996 · Aravalli Notification 1992 · ITPA 1956 · UAPA 1967 · PMLA 2002 · Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill · NCAP 2019 · National Steel Policy 2017 · DPDP 2023 · DM Act 2005 · Model Building Bye-Laws 2016 · NEP 2020 · National Credit Framework 2023 · MeghRaj Cloud Policy

## 15-question Prelims quickfire

1. CAA that froze LS seat allocation to 1971 census — **84th**
2. FATF secretariat host — **OECD** (Paris)

3. PMLA section defining money laundering — §3
4. Year of *Niyamgiri* judgment — 2013
5. Year of FRA — 2006
6. Article prohibiting human trafficking — 23
7. Supplement convention to Palermo Protocol — UNTOC
8. Strait between Iran and Oman — Hormuz
9. India's first SPR phase locations — Visakhapatnam, Mangalore, Padur
10. Article enabling President to notify STs — 342
11. India's only operational tri-service command — Andaman & Nicobar
12. Delhi's seismic zone — Zone IV
13. JCPOA primarily relates to — Iran's nuclear program
14. Geneva Convention protocol prohibiting attacks on nuclear installations — AP-I (1977), Art 56
15. DPDP 2023 adjudication body — Data Protection Board of India

## Mains essay seeds (pick one per practice cycle)

- "Federalism's clock: should India's elections all tick together?" (Stories 1 + 8)
- "Energy is foreign policy by another name." (Stories 5 + 7 + 11 + Editorial)
- "The forest, the tribe, and the law." (Stories 3 + 8)
- "Victim before criminal." (Story 4)
- "Cloud is the new crude." (Stories 14 + 15)

# Annexure A — Glossary

## DEFINITION - Delimitation

Process of fixing the number and boundaries of electoral constituencies, undertaken by an independent Delimitation Commission constituted under the Delimitation Act, 2002.

## DEFINITION - ITPA (Immoral Traffic Prevention Act, 1956)

Principal Indian statute on commercial sexual exploitation; criminalises soliciting (§7), brothel-keeping (§3), pimping (§4) but not paid sex itself.

## DEFINITION - Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG)

Sub-category of Scheduled Tribes with pre-agrarian technology, declining population, low literacy. 75 PVTGs notified across 18 states + 1 UT.

## DEFINITION - FATF Grey List

"Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring" — countries with AML/CFT strategic deficiencies actively working with FATF. Pakistan was greylisted 2018-22.

## DEFINITION - Strategic Petroleum Reserve (SPR)

Underground crude stockpile managed by ISPRL. Phase-I (5.33 MMT): Vizag, Mangalore, Padur. Phase-II: Chandikhol, Padur (under construction).

## DEFINITION - Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)

Free-trade agreement deeper than a basic FTA, additionally covering services, investment, IP, dispute settlement.

## DEFINITION - Scheduled Tribes (Article 342)

Communities notified by Presidential Order; eligibility tied historically (Lokur Committee 1965) to: geographical isolation, distinctive culture, primitive traits, shyness of contact, economic backwardness.



**DEFINITION - Sovereign Cloud**

Computing infrastructure whose data, processing, and operational control sit within national legal jurisdiction, isolated from extraterritorial subpoena.

**DEFINITION - JCPOA**

Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (2015) — Iran agreed to cap uranium enrichment to 3.67% in exchange for sanctions relief. US withdrew 2018; Iran resumed higher enrichment 2019 onwards.

# Annexure B — Static + current linkage table

| Static topic                        | Today's anchor                   | UPSC paper |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------|
| Constitutional amendments procedure | ONOE Bill, ratification req      | GS-2       |
| FRA + PESA jurisprudence            | Maharashtra mining clearance     | GS-3, GS-1 |
| Article 23 + bonded labour          | SC on ITPA prosecution           | GS-2, GS-1 |
| India's RTAs architecture           | India-Oman CEPA + data carve-out | GS-2, GS-3 |
| Indian physiography — Aravallis     | IIT-Delhi dust flux study        | GS-1       |
| External sector — oil import basket | China crude slump                | GS-3       |
| Article 25 vs Article 342           | ST delisting debate              | GS-1, GS-2 |
| Counter-terror finance              | Pahalgam phone-Pak bank          | GS-3       |
| Disaster Management Act 2005        | Delhi building collapse          | GS-3, GS-2 |
| Higher Defence Organisation         | New CNS appointment              | GS-3       |
| JCPOA + West Asia geometry          | Israel-Lebanon strikes           | GS-2       |
| Geneva Conventions AP-I             | Ukraine drone strikes            | GS-2       |
| NEP 2020 + RTE                      | CBSE OSM rollout                 | GS-2       |
| DPDP 2023 + data sovereignty        | Cloud + Oman carve-out           | GS-3       |

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